Dacarbazine — metastatic melanoma

To control metastatic melanoma with chemotherapy, with benefit, blood counts and tolerability reviewed before each treatment.

Advanced melanoma · NCCP 00464 v3 · Document revised 6 November 2026

Your personal plan: this is the standard regimen schedule. Your team confirms your prescribed doses, cycles, treatment changes and appointments in your written plan.

This is single-agent dacarbazine at the NCCP 850 mg/m² dose. It is not an immune-checkpoint or BRAF-targeted regimen. Historical studies often used 1000 mg/m² and different treatment settings; their response or survival figures are not a precise forecast for this 850 mg/m² course.

My overall treatment

Dacarbazine by IV infusion on day 1, repeated every 21 days for up to six cycles, or stopped earlier for progression or unacceptable toxicity.

Treatment course
Day 1 every 21 days, up to 6 cycles; may stop earlier.

A typical 21-day cycle

Day 1	Day 2–21
Treatment day	Between treatment visits

Timing may change after review. Side effects can occur on any day; there are no guaranteed safe days.

My tests and checks

When	What is checked	Timing / reason
Before	**Baseline safety** NCCP / current product information / individual plan	Blood count, kidneys/liver, medicines and fertility discussion.
During	**Safety checks** NCCP / current product information / individual plan	Blood count, kidneys/liver before every cycle; extra checks as needed. Lowest counts may occur 3–4 weeks after a dose.
After / response	**Follow-up** NCCP / current product information / individual plan	Blood recovery, symptom review and response scans individually planned.

Between treatments

- Infusion one hour plus checks and anti-sickness treatment. Call for fever/unwellness, bleeding, persistent vomiting or severe abdominal pain; report infusion-site burning immediately.

Bring medicine list, test dates and actual oncology/out-of-hours numbers. Example numbers must be replaced.

When to get help

Call 112 / 999 for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

Call oncology immediately: temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.

Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.

What to watch for

You do not need to know which medicine caused a symptom before calling.

1 Energy / concentration

Dacarbazine

Tiredness, anaemia, poor sleep and nausea can affect concentration. Report severe dizziness, confusion or a major change in function; do not drive if unwell.

3 Breathlessness / anaemia

Dacarbazine

Low red cells can cause tiredness or breathlessness. New or worsening breathlessness needs assessment; severe breathlessness or chest pain is an emergency.

5 Liver

Dacarbazine

Rare severe liver injury can cause abdominal pain, fever and jaundice. Seek urgent assessment; routine liver tests do not replace symptom reporting.

7 Stomach / appetite

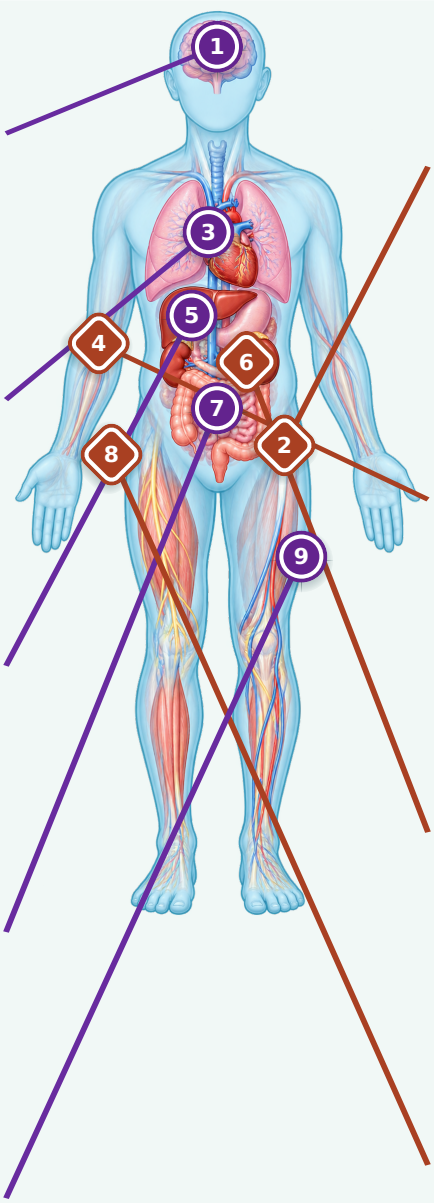
Dacarbazine

Nausea and vomiting need preventive medicines and a take-home plan. Report persistent symptoms, severe abdominal pain or failure of rescue treatment.

9 Bruising / bleeding

Dacarbazine

Low platelets can cause bruising, nosebleeds or bleeding gums. Persistent bleeding, black stools or blood in urine require prompt assessment.



2 Blood / infection

Dacarbazine

Low white cells increase infection risk and may occur late in the cycle. Fever or suddenly feeling unwell needs urgent contact, even near the next planned dose.

4 Skin / hair

Dacarbazine

Hair loss or sun sensitivity can occur. New severe rash, swelling or breathing difficulty may indicate allergy and needs urgent help.

6 Kidneys / fluids

Dacarbazine

Vomiting and reduced intake can lead to dehydration. Report reduced urine, persistent vomiting or inability to drink; kidney tests also help guide dosing.

8 Infusion site

Dacarbazine

Pain, burning, swelling or redness during infusion can mean leakage outside the vein. Tell the nurse immediately because tissue injury is possible.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Follow your unit’s fever threshold and urgent-contact instructions; call immediately if you develop fever, shaking chills or feel suddenly unwell, even without a high temperature. Also report unusual bleeding, persistent vomiting, inability to drink, reduced urine, jaundice or severe abdominal pain. Fever with abdominal pain and jaundice needs urgent assessment for rare severe liver injury. Tell the nurse immediately about infusion-site burning or swelling.

When to get help

Call 112 / 999 for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

Call oncology immediately: temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital’s temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

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Keep your treatment details to hand

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Print this page **one-sided on A4 at Actual size / 100%**. Cut only the dashed outer border around both panels. **Do not cut the centre line.** Fold with FRONT and BACK facing out, then glue or tape the blank backs together. Finished size: **85.6 × 54 mm**. Keep the stamp side writable.

FRONT / CONTACTS

My Treatment Card

SACTCheck

Name: _____

Dacarbazine

Dacarbazine by IV infusion on day 1, repeated every 21 days for up to six cycles, or stopped earlier for progression or unacceptable toxicity.

Phase: _____ Planned cycles: 6

Daytime (EXAMPLE) 087 12345678

Out of hours (EXAMPLE) 087 87654321

Unwell or fever? Call oncology now.
Severe breathing difficulty, chest pain or collapse: **112 / 999.**

EXAMPLE NUMBERS — replace before patient use.

BACK / TREATMENT RECORD

My cycle record

Team stamps after each completed cycle.

C1	C2	C3
Date / initials	Date / initials	Date / initials
C4	C5	C6
Date / initials	Date / initials	Date / initials

My treatment information

Plan changed? Ask the team to update this card.

CUT outer border

FOLD centre — do not cut

Keep the record accurate

The team dates and initials each recorded treatment unit when complete. A cycle is complete after its final planned dose; a weekly-treatment stamp records that weekly dose. Delays, omitted doses or a changed plan need a note or a replacement card. A stamp does not approve the next treatment. Keep any medicine-specific alert card too.

Put your treatment page on your phone

Scan your QR and check the treatment name. Save that page to your home screen.

iPhone / Safari

Tap Share → Add to Home Screen. Select Open as Web App if offered, then Add.

Android / Chrome

Tap the three-dot menu → Add to Home screen or Install and create shortcut. Choose the shortcut option and confirm.

Menu wording varies. The QR opens information, not a personal record. Paper stamps do not update the website. Check that the saved icon opens the correct treatment.

Your local contacts and resources

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.

Hospital / team: _____
Backup if the team cannot be reached: _____

Additional local services and resources will be added when confirmed. Your team must check and complete this page before patient use.

Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.